Das Sozio-
oekonomische
Panel

Data and Metadata Management at the German Socio-Economic Panel

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Agenda

SOEP

Data

Metadata

Outlook

SOEP

The **German Socio-Economic Panel (SOEP)** is a wide-ranging representative longitudinal study of private households, located at the German Institute for Economic Research, DIW Berlin. Every year, there were nearly **11,000 households**, and more than 20,000 persons sampled by the fieldwork organization TNS Infratest Sozialforschung.

The data provide information on all household members, consisting of Germans living in the Old and New German States, Foreigners, and recent Immigrants to Germany. The Panel was **started in 1984**.

Some of the many topics include household composition, occupational biographies, employment, earnings, health and satisfaction indicators.

`http://www.diw.de/soep`

Data

Data

- panel data (incl. spell data) on individual and household level
- wide format “SOEP-Core”
- new: long format “SOEPlong”
- innovation sample “SOEP-IS”
- related studies

Data access

- DVD, secure data download
- SOEPremote (via email, Lissy)
- remote access (first prototype)
- on site

- metadata portal “SOEPinfo” (basket, script generator)

File formats

- Stata
- SPSS
- SAS (switch to R)
- ASCII

- database: SIR

- long-term preservation: ASCII dump from SIR, incl. labels
- same dump is used for generation of Stata, SPSS, and SAS files.

Technical infrastructure

- database and processing: UNIX (AIX)
- metadata: Linux
- researchers and data managers: Windows/Linux

- Linux and UNIX: scripting!

Metadata

SOEPinfo v.1

WWW-SOEPinfo (SOEP-DB 2011 / v28 / Wave BB) - Mozilla Firefox

WWW-SOEPinfo (SOEP-DB 201...

panel.gsoep.de/soepinfo2011/

Google

[SOEPinfo-Main-Actions] [Basic Information] [Help]

Basket: 1 Vars

AP5601, AP, 1984, Supports Political Party

[Basket-Actions] Select all Clear Delete [Files]

8.1.2 Party identification

General Party Identification

Files: xP

Put all vars of this series into the basket

198				1988	1989	1990 W.	1990 E.
AP5				EP7701	FP9301	GP8501	-

1991 W.	1991 E.	1992	1993	1994	1995	1996	1997
HP9001	-	IP9001	JP9001	KP9201	LP9801	MP8401	NP9401

1998	1999	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005
OP9701	PP111	QP116	RP111	SP111	TP118	UP123	VP129

2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011
WP119	XP128	YP130	ZP123	BAP128	BBP129

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[Variables] [Topics] [Questionnaires]

javascript:add_item('722,1070,1467,1875,2224,2676,3109,3792,42...8,9028,9586,10132,10654,11226,11807,12373,12878,13436,14097')

SOEPinfo v.2 will be based on the open source project **DDI on Rails**.

DDI on Rails

Understanding Data

Vision. The data portal DDI on Rails accompanies researchers throughout the entire course of their research projects from conception to publication/citation.

The system offers researchers the possibility to explore the SOEP data, to compile personalized datasets, and to publish results on the publication database.

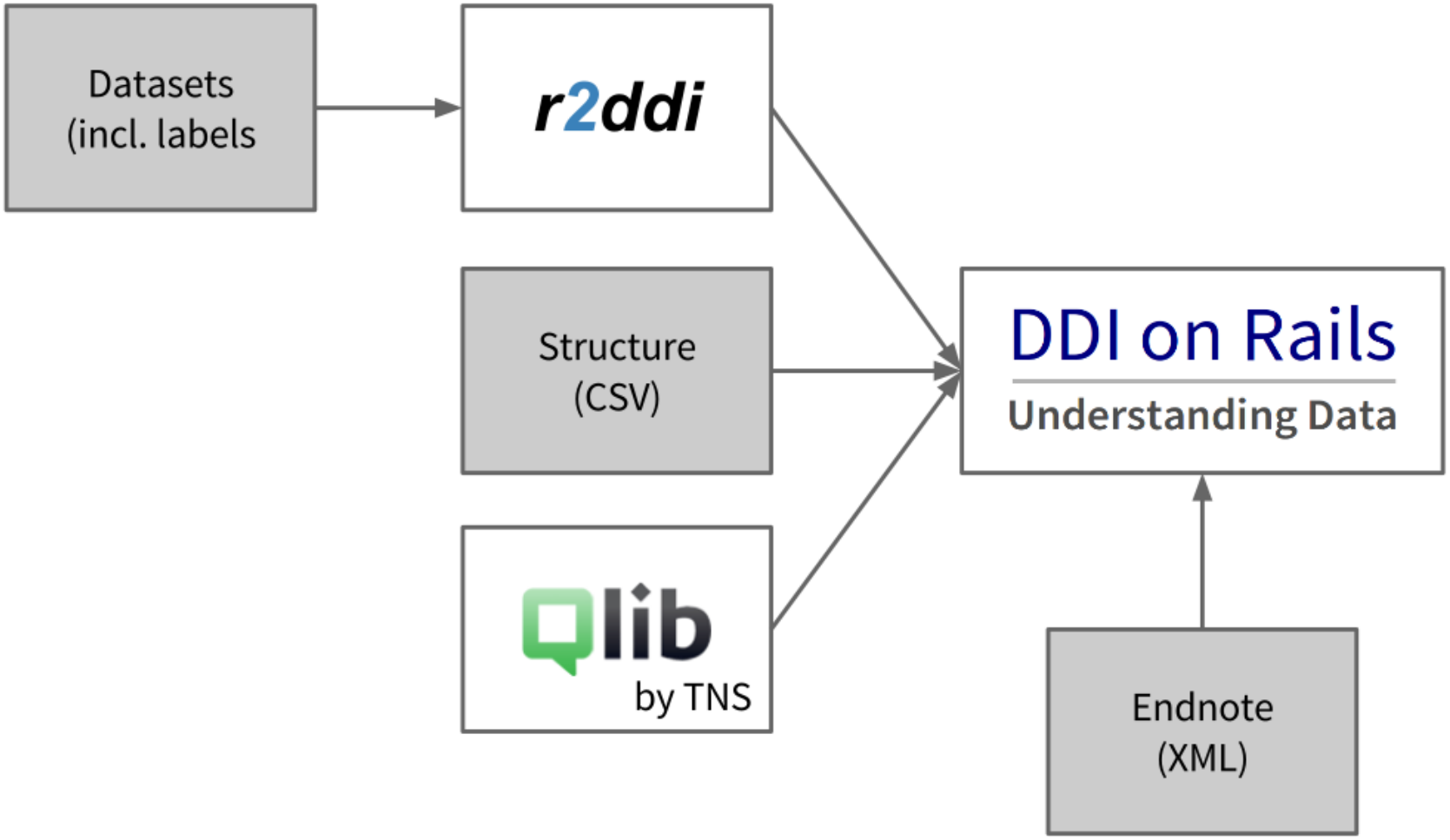
DDI on Rails = DDI + Ruby on Rails

- **Standard:** DDI (Data Documentation Initiative)
- **Web-framework:** Ruby on Rails

DDI Standard

- DDI Codebook (2.x): Import
- DDI Lifecycle (3.x): “Framework”

Architecture



Outlook

metadata-driven development

metadata-driven data processing

Links

- **Public beta:** `https://data.soep.de`
- **Internal testserver:** `http://ddionrails.soep.de` (user: guest, password: panel)
- **Project site:** `http://www.ddionrails.org`

Related Tools

- **r2ddi:** `https://github.com/mhebing/r2ddi`
- **soepR:** `https://github.com/mhebing/soepR`
- **testdata:** `https://github.com/mhebing/testdata`

Contact

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Thank you!